

QUARTER 3 REPORT 2023

NCD SMALL CRAFT REGISTRATION BOARD

Level 1, City Hall Annex Building

Waigani

National Capital District

P O Box 1392

Port Moresby



QUARTER 3 REPORT 2023

Contents

To the Board	3
IN BRIEF:	3
SURVEY & AWARENESS PROGRAM REPORT:	4
FINDINGS/OUTCOMES:	4
AREAS OF CONCERN:	5
SURVEY / REGISTRATION PROGRAM:	5
AWARENESS PROGRAM REPORT:	5
MAJOR DATA/INFORMATION EXTRACT	6
INSPECTORS CONCERNS/PERFORMANCE	8

QUARTER 3 REPORT 2023

To the Board

IN BRIEF:

1. Initial Funding of 200k received from NCDC in August.
2. Safety Awareness/Survey & Registration programs rolled out in August and are continuing
3. Registration Application Software development is underway by RMC Consultants. Expected to trial demo version by end of October.
4. Small Craft Registration Stickers (Number plates) in printing by Theodist.
5. At this stage we have the remaining villages namely Vabukori for Survey and Safety Awareness, Hanuabada and Elevala to conduct the Registration Awareness.
6. However, I suggest reviewing the Registration budget to be diverted to Media (Radio or Newspaper). Deadline to be proposed by BOARD for REGISTRATION of all small crafts. Suggesting 1 Feb 2024 with all Enforcements in implementation with Water Police.
7. Registration Certificate and Licenses/Permit formats to be approved.
8. TWL LOGISTICS have registered their fleets. Awaiting certificates to be issued.
9. We really need to acquire a Banana Boat/Dinghy. The need is of high importance now to carry out inspections, investigations, and enforcement activities efficiently. Most importantly to have a presence out there of our existence.
10. The need for a Container Office Setup at Koki Fish Market is of very high importance now, if we are to implement enforcement with Water Police. This will be convenient for inspections and registration operations/functions.
11. Additional Funding request letter sent to Member for Moresby Northwest, Hon. Lohia Boe Samuel, awaiting feedback.
12. INSURANCE: We have been hit hard by the question of Insurance! Almost in 4 villages we went, the question was raised. Unfortunately, insurance is not mentioned in the Small Craft Act. We really need to come up with a win-win situation where we can strike a balance to safeguard us and the Owners or Operators who will be registering. According to the NMSA Small Craft Division, their legal team is reviewing the act and is in consideration of an Amendment submission. But again, amendments take years to be gazette or approved by the parliament.

Sincerely,

Hitolo Garia

Registrar

October 9, 2023

QUARTER 3 REPORT 2023

SURVEY & AWARENESS PROGRAM AIRPORT:

The Survey exercise for Fisherman Island, Pari, Tatana, and Taurama village(s) were a success. We only have Vabukori, Hanuabada, and Elevala Villages to conduct. We have managed to collect some vital data or information which will help us in approaching our registration program rollout. The funding allocation this year 2023 from NCDC has assisted in implementing our Survey and part Registration program. If only the Open Electorate offices would be assisting on their part, the whole program would be a great success going forward.



FINDINGS/OUTCOMES:

During our Survey exercise, we encountered some interesting issues/feedback that were taken into consideration and are listed below;

Throughout the survey, we noticed that number of Dinghies/Boats/Motors were not in operation. Owners were very cooperative during the survey. The Inspectors managed to visit 75% of the available Owners. Few of the forms were filled up by Operators/Caretakers on behalf of the Owners. I will also highlight a few areas of concern and recommendation which will require the board's consideration and approval. Some of the points are for your, noting, reference, and information.

1. The dinghy and Motor had different owners, but operated and taken care of by another person.
2. Owner without Motor but owns a Boat/Dinghy...
3. Owner without Dinghy but owns a Motor
4. The dinghy under major repair and the Motor require overhauling.
5. Despite the defects, the owner still operates which is not safe.

QUARTER 3 REPORT 2023

6. Inconsistency of Pre-Departure checks
7. Inconsistency in Standard Safety gears/equipment checklist. (E.g. Some boats do not carry life jackets, compass, signal devices, etc. sometimes or not all all.)
8. Not many operators/boat owners are aware of the Small Craft Act.
9. Awareness through Radio and door-to-door visits has tallied highest. Which indicated to us that the radio/DTD is required and effective.
10. Most Dinghy owners have raised the concern of an economical Tracking system/solution to be provided.
11. Owners requesting for Insurance policies.

AREAS OF CONCERN:

All or most Boats/Dinghies are not geared with proper Safety equipment which is alarming given the recent incidents of missing fishermen from Hanuabada and Pari. Many have also brought up the matter of Insurance.

During the Survey program, the highlighted point was on Insurance issue. We had to advise the owners/Operators that the issue would be forwarded to NMSA and the board for further review.

SURVEY AND REGISTRATION PROGRAM:

The survey and Registration program has also been rolled out in Fisherman Island and Pari Village. However, the outcome of the Registration was not as good as expected. Thus, we have decided to put it on hold especially the Registration for the meantime. We will resume in January 2024 and inform all villages that the deadline for Registration will be in February whilst penalties will be effective in March 2024. We will also require additional Registration Stickers to be ready before the end of December 2023.

SAFETY AWARENESS PROGRAM REPORT:

We continued Awareness as stated earlier.

1. Door to door – we did a few along with the Survey / Registration program.
2. Outdoor – good outturn by Owners and operators. Even non-owners were eager to participate.
3. Radio – we continued our Safety ads/messages with Lalokau FM through the allocated budget.

QUARTER 3 REPORT 2023

MAJOR DATA/INFORMATION EXTRACT

➤ FIAHERMAN ISLAND DATA

1. TOTAL BOATS/DINGHIES WITH MOTOR = 21
 - Remaining survey forms to be collected and Data to be updated.

➤ PARI DATA

2. TOTAL BOATS/DINGHIES WITH MOTOR IN PARI = 40
 - Remaining survey forms to be collected and Data to be updated.

➤ TAURAMA DATA

3. TOTAL BOATS/DINGHIES WITH MOTOR = 10
 - Remaining survey forms to be collected and Data to be updated.

➤ TATANA DATA

4. TOTAL BOATS/DINGHIES WITH MOTOR = 20
 - Remaining survey forms to be collected and Data to be updated.

For VABUKORI, HANUABADA, And ELEVALA, we will conduct the final Survey and report with the final figures.

All figures are shown according to the survey exercise carried out in each village visited. It is subject to change during the registration rollout.

